

My grandmother traded equities. I got involved in stock trading through her. She was a long-term investor and did very well at it. She was a very strong woman. She wasn't interested in baking a cake for me; she was interested in what stock I wanted to buy or sell. I told my grandmother about a trust savings bank whose shares were going to be floated. "It's going to open at a premium," I told her, "because they are going to sell it cheap so everyone buys the shares."

She said, "Okay, then let's get involved." She asked me, "How much do you want to buy?"

"As much as I can," I told her.

She said, "Okay, I'll lend you the money." She lent me the cash, and I filled out the application forms, which were clearly in her name. We bought £500 or £1,000 of stock—I don't remember the exact amount—at £.50, and it opened at £.99.

How did you get the idea to buy the stock?

I read about it. When I was 12 or 13 years old, I got a copy of this magazine called *Investors Chronicle*, which had interesting articles about the market, trading options, and lots of company analyses. I read it every week after that. By the time I was 14, I knew every single stat on every single company. At the time, the U.K. was going through a privatization phase, and I was just buying all of the stocks when they went public and flipping them. I must have made £20,000 to £30,000.

This is all while you were still in high school?

Yes. When I was at university, I continued trading my own account. I got hammered in the stock market crash of 1987.

Tell me about that experience.

I woke up that Monday morning and glanced out the window. It looked like there was some sort of hurricane going on in London. Trees had been knocked down. The place looked like a bombsite. I thought to myself, "What a terrible morning." I turned on the radio and that's when I heard the stock market was crashing.

How much of your money did you have invested at the time?